

Vector Calculus

Vector Calculus

COORDINATE SYSTEMS

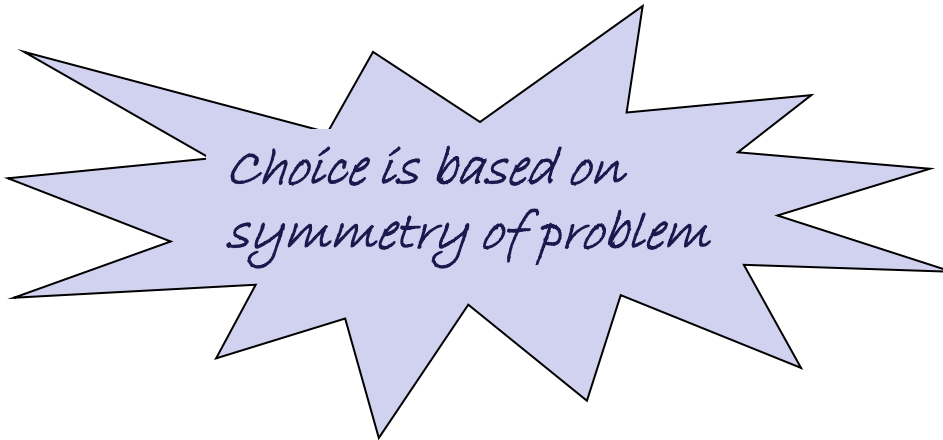
- RECTANGULAR or Cartesian
- CYLINDRICAL
- SPHERICAL

Examples:

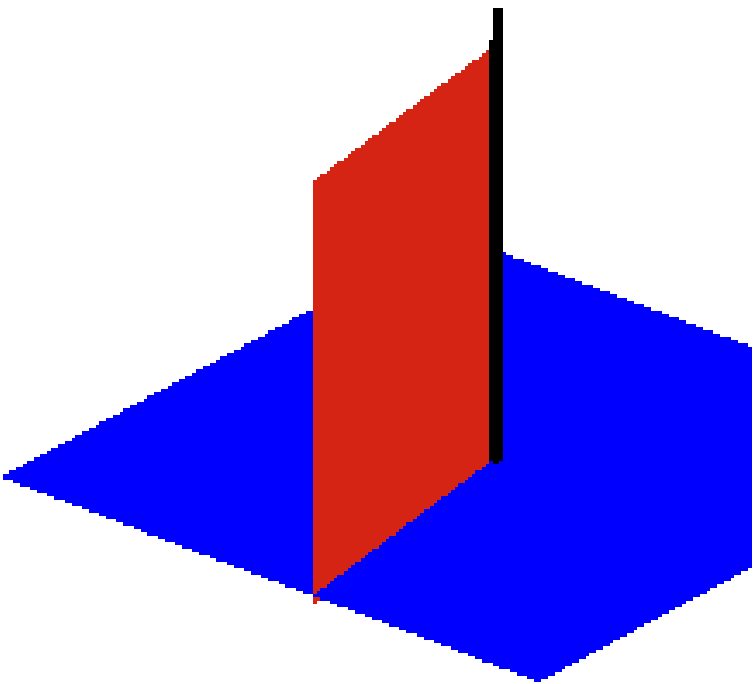
Sheets - RECTANGULAR

Wires/cables - CYLINDRICAL

Spheres - SPHERICAL



Choice is based on
symmetry of problem



Cylindrical Symmetry



Spherical Symmetry

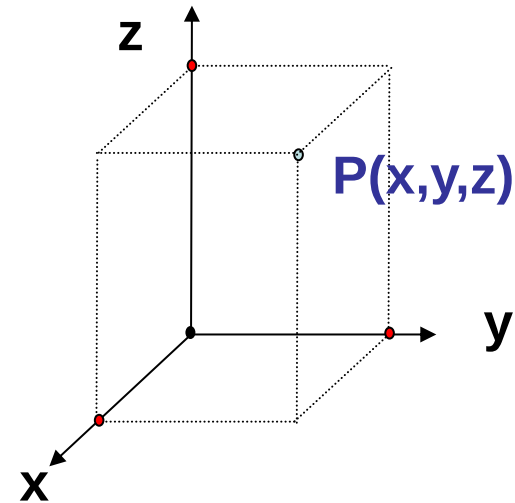
Cartesian Coordinates Or Rectangular Coordinates

P (x, y, z)

$$-\infty < x < \infty$$

$$-\infty < y < \infty$$

$$-\infty < z < \infty$$



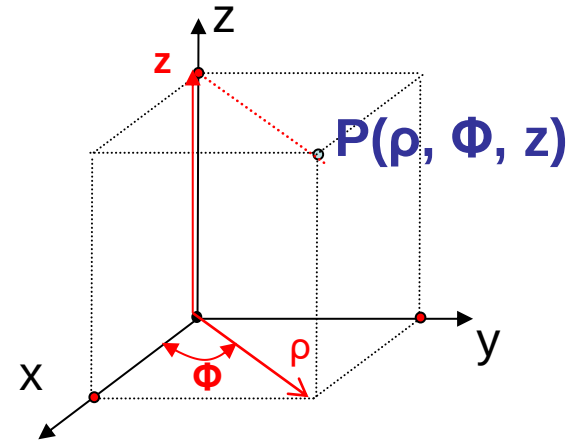
A vector A in Cartesian coordinates can be written as

$$(A_x, A_y, A_z) \quad \text{or} \quad A_x a_x + A_y a_y + A_z a_z$$

where a_x, a_y and a_z are unit vectors along x, y and z-directions.

Cylindrical Coordinates

$$\begin{aligned} P(\rho, \Phi, z) \quad & 0 \leq \rho < \infty \\ & 0 \leq \phi < 2\pi \\ & -\infty < z < \infty \end{aligned}$$



A vector A in Cylindrical coordinates can be written as

$$(A_\rho, A_\phi, A_z) \quad \text{or} \quad A_\rho a_\rho + A_\phi a_\phi + A_z a_z$$

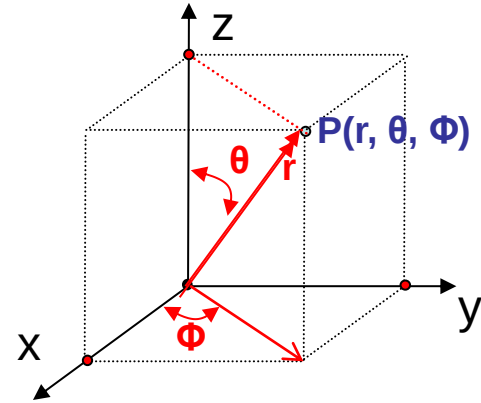
where a_ρ, a_ϕ and a_z are unit vectors along ρ, Φ and z -directions.

$$x = \rho \cos \Phi, \quad y = \rho \sin \Phi, \quad z = z$$

$$\rho = \sqrt{x^2 + y^2}, \quad \phi = \tan^{-1} \frac{y}{x}, \quad z = z$$

Spherical Coordinates

$$\begin{aligned} P(r, \theta, \Phi) \quad & 0 \leq r < \infty \\ & 0 \leq \theta \leq \pi \\ & 0 \leq \phi < 2\pi \end{aligned}$$



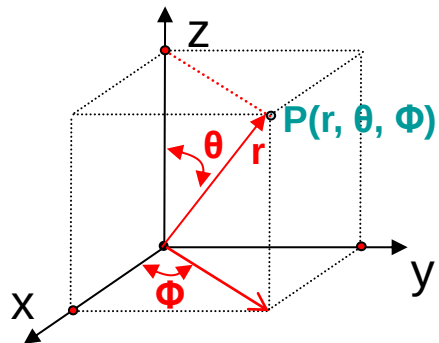
A vector A in Spherical coordinates can be written as

$$(A_r, A_\theta, A_\phi) \quad \text{or} \quad A_r a_r + A_\theta a_\theta + A_\phi a_\phi$$

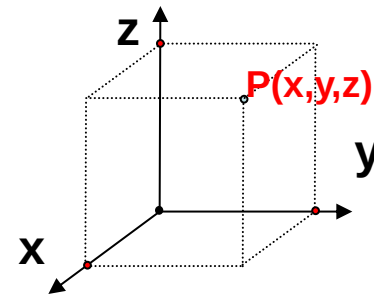
where a_r , a_θ , and a_ϕ are unit vectors along r , θ , and Φ -directions.

$$x = r \sin \theta \cos \Phi, \quad y = r \sin \theta \sin \Phi, \quad z = r \cos \theta$$

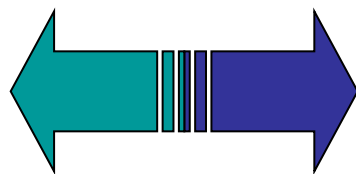
$$r = \sqrt{x^2 + y^2 + z^2}, \quad \theta = \tan^{-1} \frac{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}}{z}, \quad \phi = \tan^{-1} \frac{y}{x}$$



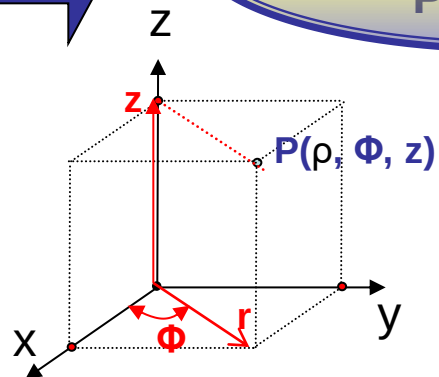
Cartesian Coordinates
 $P(x, y, z)$



Spherical Coordinates
 $P(r, \theta, \phi)$



Cylindrical Coordinates
 $P(\rho, \phi, z)$



Differential Length, Area and Volume

Cartesian Coordinates

Differential displacement

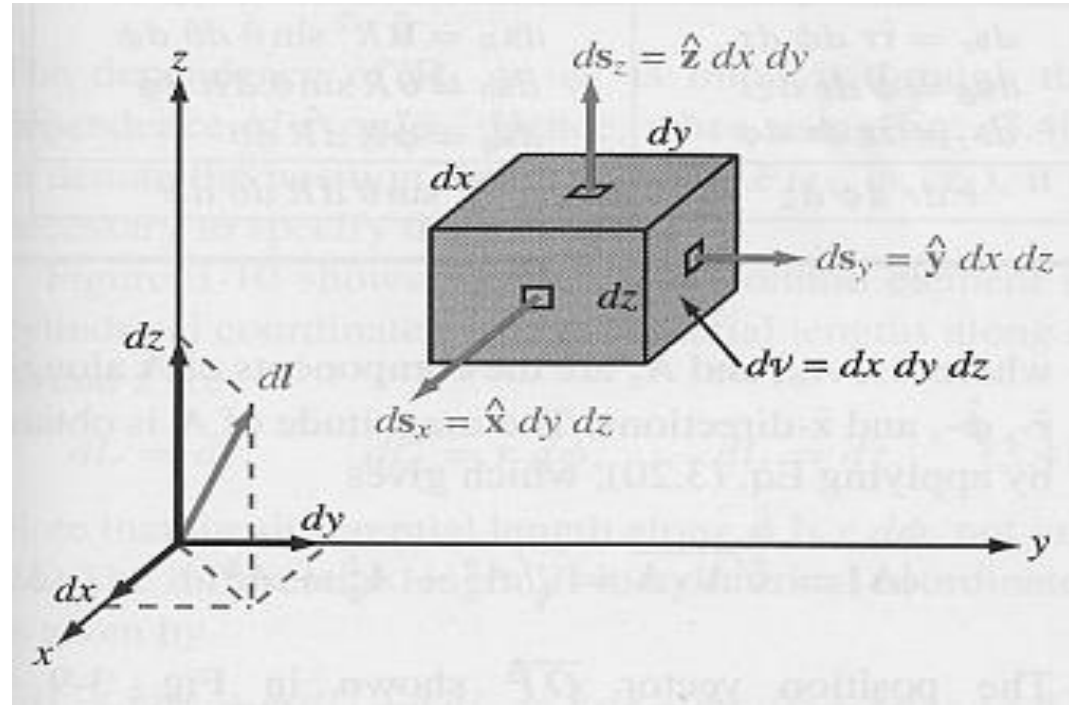
$$dl = dxa_x + dya_y + dza_z$$

Differential area

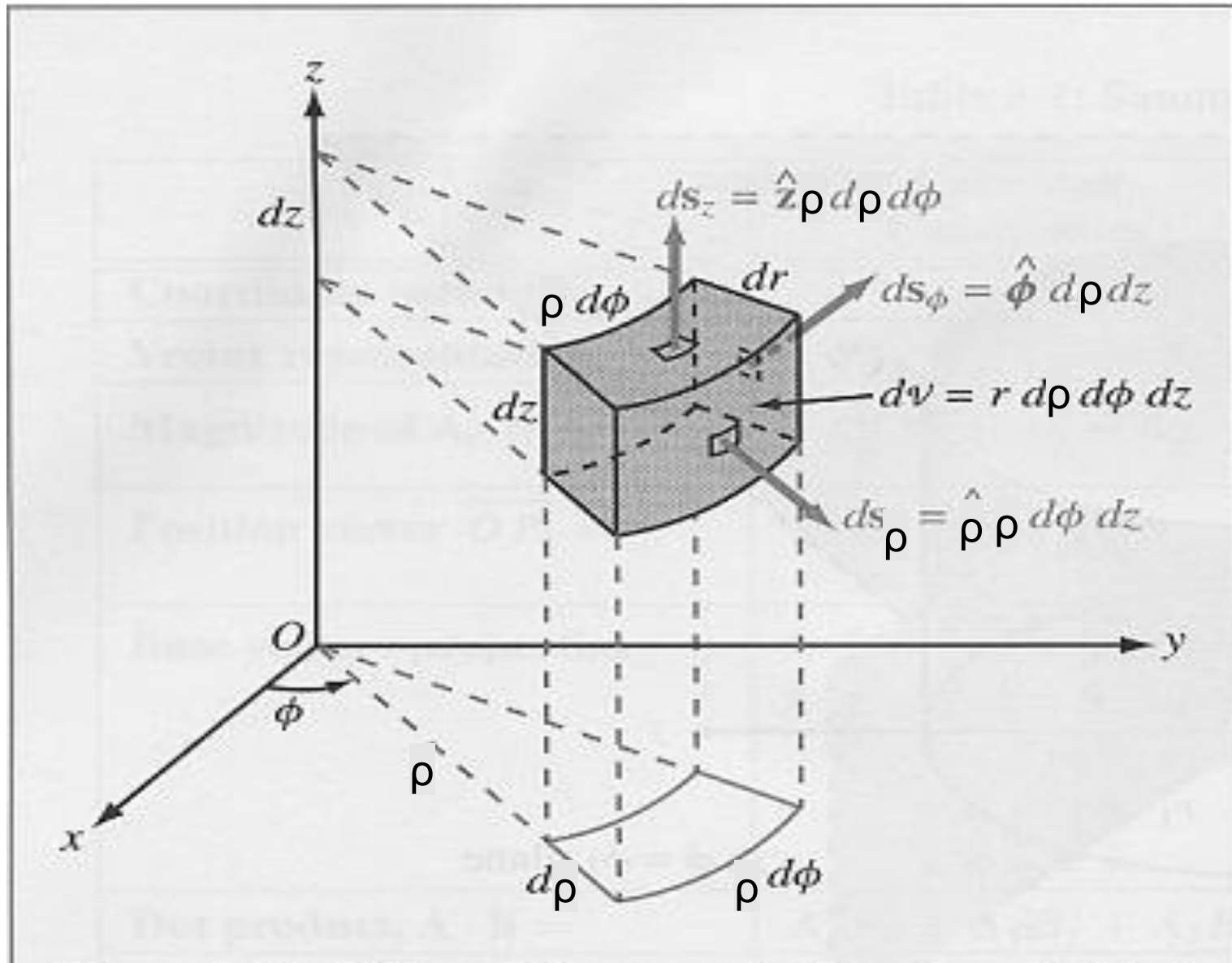
$$dS = dydza_x = dxdza_y = dx dy a_z$$

Differential Volume

$$dV = dxdydz$$



Cylindrical Coordinates



Differential Length, Area and Volume

Cylindrical Coordinates

Differential displacement

$$dl = d\rho a_\rho + \rho d\phi a_\phi + dz a_z$$

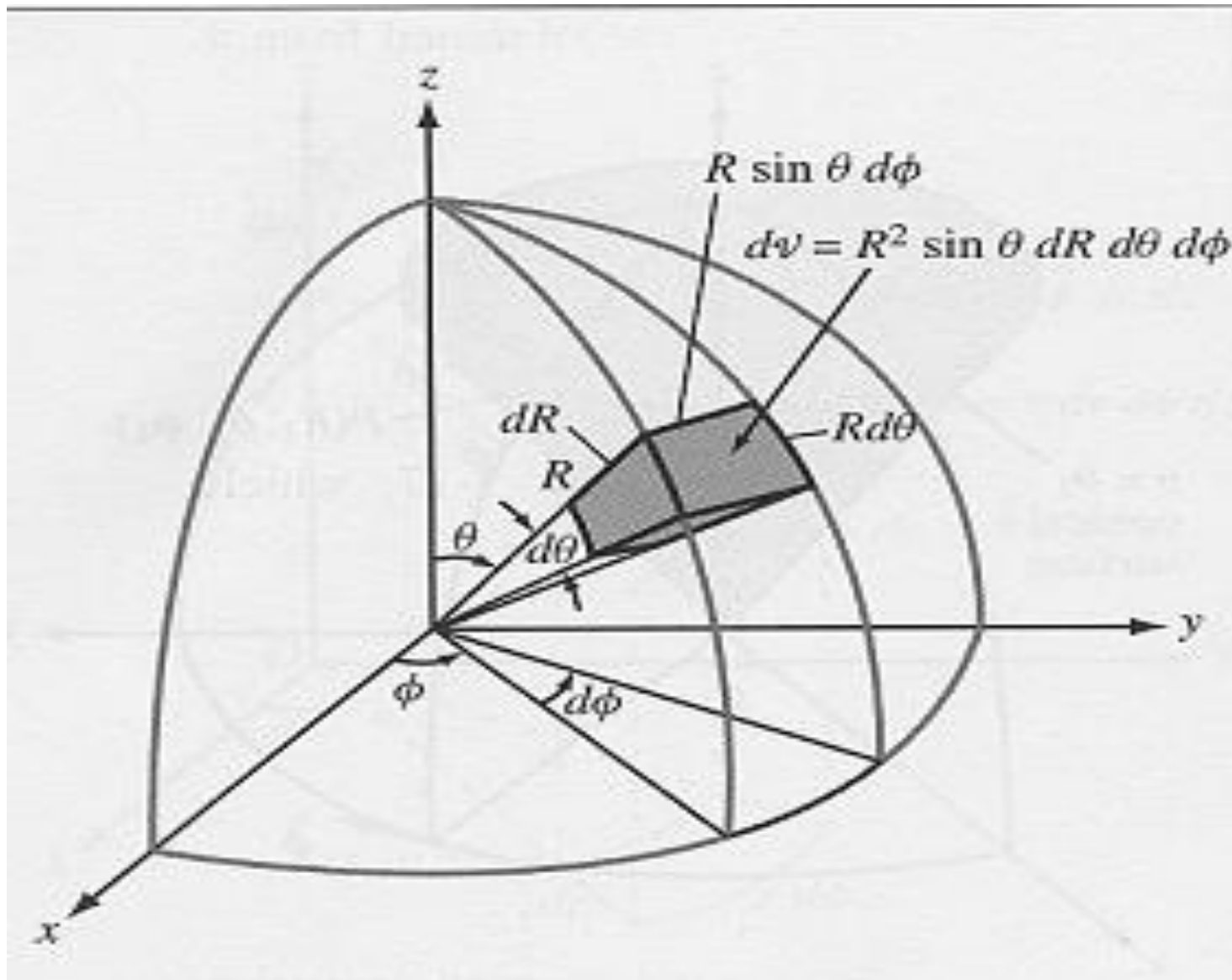
Differential area

$$dS = \rho d\phi dz a_\rho = d\rho dz a_\phi = \rho d\rho d\phi a_z$$

Differential Volume

$$dV = \rho d\rho d\phi dz$$

Spherical Coordinates



Differential Length, Area and Volume

Spherical Coordinates

Differential displacement

$$dl = dr\mathbf{a}_r + r d\theta\mathbf{a}_\theta + r \sin \theta d\phi\mathbf{a}_\phi$$

Differential area

$$dS = r^2 \sin \theta d\theta d\phi \mathbf{a}_r = r \sin \theta dr d\phi \mathbf{a}_\theta = r dr d\theta \mathbf{a}_\phi$$

Differential Volume

$$dV = r^2 \sin \theta dr d\theta d\phi$$

Line, Surface and Volume Integrals

Line Integral

$$\oint_L A \cdot dl$$

Surface Integral

$$\psi = \int_S A \cdot dS$$

Volume Integral

$$\int_V p_v dv$$

Gradient, Divergence and Curl

The Del Operator

$$\nabla = \frac{\partial}{\partial x} i + \frac{\partial}{\partial y} j + \frac{\partial}{\partial z} k$$

- Gradient of a scalar function is a vector quantity.
- Divergence of a vector is a scalar quantity.
- Curl of a vector is a vector quantity.

$$\nabla f \longrightarrow \text{Vector}$$

$$\nabla \cdot A$$

$$\nabla \times A$$

Del Operator

Cartesian Coordinates

$$\nabla = \frac{\partial}{\partial x} a_x + \frac{\partial}{\partial y} a_y + \frac{\partial}{\partial z} a_z$$

Cylindrical Coordinates

$$\nabla = \frac{\partial}{\partial \rho} a_\rho + \frac{1}{\rho} \frac{\partial}{\partial \phi} a_\phi + \frac{\partial}{\partial z} a_z$$

Spherical Coordinates

$$\nabla = \frac{\partial}{\partial r} a_r + \frac{1}{r} \frac{\partial}{\partial \theta} a_\theta + \frac{1}{r \sin \theta} \frac{\partial}{\partial \phi} a_\phi$$

Gradient of a Scalar

The gradient of a scalar field V is a vector that represents both the magnitude and the direction of the maximum space rate of increase of V .

$$\nabla V = \frac{\partial V}{\partial x} a_x + \frac{\partial V}{\partial y} a_y + \frac{\partial V}{\partial z} a_z$$

$$\nabla V = \frac{\partial V}{\partial \rho} a_\rho + \frac{1}{\rho} \frac{\partial V}{\partial \phi} a_\phi + \frac{\partial V}{\partial z} a_z$$

$$\nabla V = \frac{\partial V}{\partial r} a_r + \frac{1}{r} \frac{\partial V}{\partial \theta} a_\theta + \frac{1}{r \sin \theta} \frac{\partial V}{\partial \phi} a_\phi$$

Gradient of a scalar field

Let $\phi(x, y, z)$ be any continuous differential scalar function. Then, gradient of scalar function $\phi(x, y, z)$ is mathematically written as

$$\vec{\nabla} \phi = \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial x} \hat{i} + \frac{\partial}{\partial y} \hat{j} + \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \hat{k} \right) \phi = \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial x} \hat{i} + \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial y} \hat{j} + \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial z} \hat{k}$$

$$\text{or } \underline{\text{grad } \phi} = \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial x} \hat{i} + \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial y} \hat{j} + \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial z} \hat{k}$$

$\underline{\text{grad } \phi}$ is a vector.

Physical Significance

$$\text{grad } \phi = \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial n} \hat{n}$$

Thus gradient of a scalar function ϕ at any point is a vector whose magnitude at any point is equal to the maximum rate of increase of ϕ and directed along the direction in which the maximum change occurs i.e., perpendicular to level surface at that point. *In simple word, gradient of scalar function represent the maximum rate of change of scalar function.*

Divergence of a vector

The divergence of A at a given point P is the outward flux per unit volume as the volume shrinks about P .

$$\text{div}A = \nabla \cdot A = \lim_{\Delta v \rightarrow 0} \frac{\oint_S A \cdot dS}{\Delta v}$$

$$\nabla \cdot A = \frac{\partial A_x}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial A_y}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial A_z}{\partial z}$$

$$\nabla \cdot A = \frac{1}{\rho} \frac{\partial}{\partial \rho} (\rho A_\rho) + \frac{1}{\rho} \frac{\partial A_\phi}{\partial \phi} + \frac{\partial A_z}{\partial z}$$

Curl of a vector

The curl of A is an axial vector whose magnitude is the maximum circulation of A per unit area tends to zero and whose direction is the normal direction of the area when the area is oriented to make the circulation maximum.

$$\text{curl}A = \nabla \times A = \left(\lim_{\Delta S \rightarrow 0} \frac{\oint_L A \cdot dl}{\Delta S} \right)_{\max} a_n$$

Where ΔS is the area bounded by the curve L and a_n is the unit vector normal to the surface ΔS

$$\nabla \times \mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} a_x & a_y & a_z \\ \frac{\partial}{\partial x} & \frac{\partial}{\partial y} & \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \\ A_x & A_y & A_z \end{bmatrix}$$

Cartesian Coordinates

$$\nabla \times \mathbf{A} = \frac{1}{\rho} \begin{bmatrix} a_\rho & \rho a_\phi & a_z \\ \frac{\partial}{\partial \rho} & \frac{\partial}{\partial \phi} & \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \\ A_\rho & \rho A_\phi & A_z \end{bmatrix}$$

Cylindrical Coordinates

$$\nabla \times \mathbf{A} = \frac{1}{r^2 \sin \theta} \begin{bmatrix} a_r & r a_\theta & r \sin \theta a_\phi \\ \frac{\partial}{\partial r} & \frac{\partial}{\partial \theta} & \frac{\partial}{\partial \phi} \\ A_r & r A_\theta & r \sin \theta A_\phi \end{bmatrix}$$

Spherical Coordinates

Divergence or Gauss' Theorem

The divergence theorem states that the total outward flux of a vector field A through the closed surface S is the same as the volume integral of the divergence of A .

$$\oint A \cdot dS = \int_V \nabla \cdot A dv$$

Stokes' Theorem

Stokes's theorem states that the circulation of a vector field A around a closed path L is equal to the surface integral of the curl of A over the open surface S bounded by L , provided A and $\nabla \times A$ are continuous on S

$$\oint_L A \cdot dl = \int_S (\nabla \times A) \cdot dS$$

Q.1 Vector of magnitude of 5 units making an angle 60° with the x-axis. Find its components along x-axis and y-axis.

Horizontal component $A_x = |A| \cos \alpha = 5 \cos 60^\circ = 5 \times \frac{1}{2} = 2.5$ units

Vertical component $A_y = |A| \sin \alpha = 5 \sin 60^\circ = 5 \times \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$ units

Q.2 One of the rectangular components of the force 10 N is 8 N. Find the other components of the force.

$F=10\text{ N}$ Let $F_x=8\text{ N}$ and $F_y=?$

$$F = \sqrt{F_x^2 + F_y^2} \Rightarrow F_y = \sqrt{F^2 - F_x^2}$$

$$= \sqrt{(10)^2 - (8)^2} = \sqrt{36} = 6$$

$$F_y = 6\text{ N}$$



Q.3 $\vec{A} = 2\hat{i} + 3\hat{j} + 2\hat{k}$ and $\vec{B} = 3\hat{i} + 4\hat{j} - 9\hat{k}$. What is the angle between these two vectors $\vec{A}$ and $\vec{B}$

$$\cos \theta = \frac{\vec{A} \cdot \vec{B}}{AB}$$

$$|A| = \sqrt{4 + 9 + 4} = \sqrt{17}$$

$$|B| = \sqrt{9 + 16 + 81} = \sqrt{106}$$

$$A \cdot B = 6 + 12 - 18 = 0$$

$$\cos \theta = 0 \Rightarrow \theta = \frac{\pi}{2}$$

Q.4 If $\vec{A} = 2\hat{i} + 3\hat{j} + 2\hat{k}$ and $\vec{B} = 3\hat{i} + 4\hat{j} + 9\hat{k}$. Find the scalar and cross product of two vectors.

$$\text{Scalar product} = \vec{A} \cdot \vec{B} = (2\hat{i} + 3\hat{j} + 2\hat{k}) \cdot (3\hat{i} + 4\hat{j} + 9\hat{k}) = 6 + 12 + 18 = 36$$

$$\text{Cross product } \vec{A} \times \vec{B} = \begin{vmatrix} \hat{i} & \hat{j} & \hat{k} \\ 2 & 3 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 & 9 \end{vmatrix}$$


Find a vector which is perpendicular to $\vec{A} = 6\hat{i} + 9\hat{j}$ and $\vec{B} = -2\hat{i} + 7\hat{j}$

$$\hat{n} = \frac{\vec{A} \times \vec{B}}{|\vec{A} \times \vec{B}|}$$

$$\vec{A} \times \vec{B} = \hat{i}(0) - \hat{j}(0) + \hat{k}(42 + 18)$$

$$\vec{A} \times \vec{B} = 60\hat{k}$$

$$|\vec{A} \times \vec{B}| = 60$$

$$\hat{n} = \frac{\vec{A} \times \vec{B}}{|\vec{A} \times \vec{B}|} = \frac{60\hat{k}}{60} = \hat{k}$$